

Deep vein thrombosis (DVT) — Diagnosis & treatment

Source: Mayo Clinic

Diagnosis

To diagnose DVT, your health care provider will do a physical exam and ask questions about your symptoms. The provider will check the legs for swelling, tenderness or changes in skin color.

The tests you have depend on whether your provider thinks you are at a low or a high risk of DVT.

Treatment

There are three main goals to deep vein thrombosis (DVT) treatment:

- Prevent the clot from getting bigger.
- Prevent the clot from breaking loose and traveling to the lungs.
- Reduce the chances of another DVT.

DVT treatment options include:

Blood thinners. These medicines, also called anticoagulants, help prevent blood clots from getting bigger. Blood thinners reduce the risk of developing more clots. Blood thinners may be taken by mouth or given by intravenous (IV) or an injection under the skin. There are different types of blood thinners.

Compression stockings

Compression stockings, also called support stockings, press on the legs, improving blood flow. A stocking butler may help with putting on the stockings.

Self care

After deep vein thrombosis (DVT) treatment, follow these tips to manage the condition and prevent complications or more blood clots:

Take medications as directed. Your provider will tell you how long you need treatment. If you're taking certain blood thinners, you'll need regular blood tests to see how well your blood is clotting.

Watch for excessive bleeding. This can be a side effect of blood thinners. Ask your care provider about the warning signs. Know what to do if bleeding happens. Also ask your provider if you have activity restrictions. Minor injuries that cause bruising or even a simple cut may become serious if you're taking blood thinners.

Move. If you've been on bed rest because of surgery or other reasons, the sooner you get moving, the lower the chance that blood clots will develop.

Wear support stockings. Wear these to help prevent blood clots in the legs if your provider recommends them.

Preparing for your appointment

DVT is considered a medical emergency. It's important to get treated quickly. If there's time before your appointment, here's some information to help you get ready.

What you can do — Make a list of:

- Your symptoms, including any that seem unrelated to deep vein thrombosis.
- What, if anything, makes your symptoms worse.

By Mayo Clinic Staff — Jun 11, 2022

Original source:

[mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/deep-vein-thrombosis/diagnosis-treatment/drc-20352563](https://www.mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/deep-vein-thrombosis/diagnosis-treatment/drc-20352563)